In the Guise of an Introduction

As my editor called it, this text is a *cri de coeur*. In December 2022, I had no intention of writing anything new beyond what had already been written and almost forgotten. But in January 2023, here I was, busy inscribing daily a kind of a journal of Israeli political events, quite instinctively adding, by association, comments that came to mind and various reminiscences. All this was done on the spur of the moment. Indeed, *un cri de coeur*. Why?

It took me a few days to understand that the political coalition Netanyahu had set up following the election was a monster, a monster with teeth that could devour the country. It took me a few more days to realize that each Israeli—those who lived in the country first and foremost, but also those who lived elsewhere and were attached to it, as I was—had to contribute what they could to stop the monster. I couldn't do more, because of age and health, but a diary seemed better than nothing.

Of course, I could have relied on the assurances given by our prime minister, that the liberal, democratic regime enjoyed by Israel would in no case be erased, that he was completely in charge in deciding what was allowed and what was not. It was possibly his intention when he promised this, but two elements of the situation made me wary. I knew what political fanaticism was, and I knew that Netanyahu was desperately attempting to get rid of the indictments which could land him in jail. His new alliances would allow him to subvert the judicial system to a point that would make it subservient to the political majority in power and thus allow him to dodge the sword hanging over his head.

Over the spring and summer, Israelis became increasingly aware of what the stakes were. They protested in the face of a minority of messianic